



AMAJUBA ECONOMIC CHAMBER

Promoting Growth & Prosperity

KwaZulu-Natal • South Africa

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To:

The Head of Department
Local Economic Development (LED) Unit
Newcastle Local Municipality

SUBJECT:

Proposal for Community Capacity-Building, Governance Literacy and Local Economic Development Training Programme

Dear Sir/Madam,

The Amajuba Economic Chamber hereby formally submits this proposal for the establishment of a Community Capacity-Building and Economic Empowerment Programme to be implemented in partnership with the Local Economic Development (LED) Departments of Newcastle Local Municipality and Amajuba District Municipality.

This initiative is aimed at strengthening community economic participation, governance literacy, skills development, and responsible utilisation of public and development funding, in alignment with municipal LED mandates, inclusive growth strategies, and sustainable development objectives.



Background and Rationale

Communities across the Amajuba District continue to face challenges related to:

- Limited understanding of government systems and funding mechanisms
- Inadequate knowledge of tendering and procurement processes
- Poor awareness of municipal structures, roles, and responsibilities
- Low levels of governance literacy and civic education
- Weak capacity to effectively manage and utilise funds when accessed
- Limited participation in economic development opportunities

As a result, many community members, cooperatives, SMMEs, and community structures are unable to fully benefit from available public resources, economic opportunities, and development programmes.

This programme seeks to build practical knowledge, competence, accountability, and community-level capacity, enabling communities to engage meaningfully with government systems and participate sustainably in local economic development.



Programme Objectives

The programme will provide structured training and facilitation in the following key areas:

1. Tendering and Procurement Systems

- Understanding municipal procurement processes
- Tender application procedures
- Compliance requirements
- Ethical participation in procurement
- Business readiness and documentation

2. Government Funding Utilisation

- Financial literacy for development funding
- Responsible fund management
- Project planning and budgeting
- Accountability and reporting
- Sustainability planning

3. Municipal Governance Education

- Roles and responsibilities of municipal councillors
- Roles of ward committees
- Community participation structures
- Public accountability mechanisms
- Civic rights and responsibilities

4. Community Leadership and Civic Education

- Community development structures
- Participatory governance



- Community organising
- Leadership ethics
- Conflict resolution
- Community accountability frameworks

5. Economic Participation and Development Literacy

- LED structures and opportunities
- Cooperative development
- Informal trader development
- Youth enterprise development
- Community enterprise models



Local Facilitation, Accreditation and Job Creation

A core principle of this programme is the use of capable, accredited local facilitators drawn from communities within the district. This model will:

- Recognise existing community-based skills and expertise
- Create paid facilitation opportunities
- Generate local employment
- Build sustainable community-based training capacity
- Enable skills transfer
- Strengthen local economic circulation
- Develop a community-owned development ecosystem

All facilitators will be appropriately accredited and compensated, ensuring professional delivery standards while simultaneously creating economic opportunities within the communities themselves.



Alignment with LED Mandates

This programme directly supports LED objectives through:

- Local skills development
- Community empowerment
- Enterprise development
- Employment creation
- Inclusive economic participation
- Sustainable development
- Institutional strengthening
- Social and economic resilience building



Implementation Approach

The programme will be implemented through:

- Community-based workshops
- Structured training modules
- Accredited facilitation
- Practical learning models
- Participatory learning methods
- Outcomes-based assessments
- Community development forums
- Ongoing monitoring and evaluation

Strategic Opportunity: This initiative presents a strategic opportunity to build informed, empowered, economically active communities that are capable of responsibly accessing, managing, and growing development resources for long-term impact.



Request for Partnership Engagement

The Amajuba Economic Chamber respectfully requests an engagement with the LED Departments to:

- Present this programme in detail
- Explore partnership frameworks
- Discuss pilot implementation opportunities
- Align funding mechanisms
- Establish a sustainable rollout model across the district

Yours faithfully,

Themba Khanyile

Chairperson

Amajuba Economic Chamber

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